

Christopher Vistal

Backend-leaning Software Engineer · Laravel · Vue.js · AWS · Open to remote roles + contracts

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SUMMARY

Backend-leaning Software Engineer with **5+ years** shipping production web platforms **end-to-end**, from system design and database modeling through REST APIs, deployment, and security hardening. Domain experience across legal, government, university, and on-device AI systems. **Open to full-time remote roles and select contracts.**

EXPERIENCE

Freelance Software Engineer 2023 – Present
Independent Contractor

- Designed and shipped **ATA Law Firm's case management platform** on AWS, in **daily production use for over a year by up to 10 attorneys and support staff** at a leading Surigao del Sur law firm: case tracking, document automation, REST APIs, and a secure client portal with **role-based access control** modeled on attorney-client privilege.
- Built **NEMSU Data Hub**, a multi-campus file and submissions platform across **NEMSU's 4 campuses**, currently in deployment, with resumable uploads, queue-backed virus scanning, and cryptographically signed PDF documents.
- Engineered an **offline, on-device AI transcription tool** for confidential legal and medical audio, with zero cloud dependency.

Software Engineer Jan 2021 – Dec 2023
Province of Surigao del Sur

- Built the province's **E-PDS records platform and tourism dashboard**, digitizing **500+ civil-servant files** and giving planners live visitor data.
- Delivered an internal tooling suite (GSIS deductions, BIR tax reporting, SMS notifications, an Android 201-files app) that cut routine paperwork **from hours to minutes**.
- Cut response times on high-traffic reporting views by **~60%**, profiling queries, resolving N+1 bottlenecks, and adding indexes on legacy applications.
- Introduced Git, code review, and CI/CD deployment** to the team, cutting integration friction across government projects.
- Mentored **3 engineers** on Laravel, server environments, and release procedures.

SKILLS

Backend	PHP / Laravel · Spatie packages · Node.js / Express · MySQL / SQL Server · REST APIs · queue pipelines · Socket.io
Frontend	Vue.js · TypeScript · Tailwind CSS · Inertia.js · HTML / CSS / JS
AI & ML	Python · CTranslate2 · Whisper · NLP · Speech-to-Text · on-device inference · Claude / Claude Code (AI-assisted development)
DevOps & Security	Git / GitHub · CI/CD · AWS (EC2, S3, RDS) · Docker · Nginx · Cloudflare · ClamAV · role-based access control · PHPUnit / Pest · Linux
Go & Other	Go (tus, Bubbletea, PDF signing) · system design · Java (Android) · C# (.NET)

SELECTED PROJECTS

ATA Law Firm [case study](#) · atafirm.ph
Production case management system, case tracking, document automation, client portal on AWS. Laravel, Vue.js.

NEMSU Data Hub [case study](#) · in deployment
File + submissions platform for NEMSU's 4 campuses, Google Drive style. Laravel + Vue + Go tus uploads + ClamAV + Google Workspace.

Offline AI Transcriber [case study](#)
Local speech-to-text with real-time waveform visualization, no cloud, fully on-device. Python, CTranslate2, Whisper.

Provincial Records & Tourism Platform [case study](#)
Civil servant records platform + tourism analytics for Province of Surigao del Sur. Laravel, Vue.js, MySQL, SQL Server.

EDUCATION

Surigao del Sur State University 2015 – 2019
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science